Compliance Relay Worksheet

How much of a regulatory deadline actually reaches your engineers? Fill in the boxes in weeks unless noted. Use your own numbers.

A. THE CLOCK AND THE WORK

Clock starts (date) _____

Deadline (date, e.g. CRA full application 11 Dec 2027) _____

Calendar weeks between them _____

Engineering work needed (weeks of full team time) _____

B. HANDOFFS BEFORE ENGINEERS SEE IT

HANDOFF	WEEKS	PARALLEL WITH ABOVE?
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

Total handoff weeks (parallel steps count once, as the longest) _____

C. WAITING BEFORE WORK CAN START

Extra wait for standards or guidance (beyond the handoffs) _____

Wait for the next planning cycle (0 if work can enter mid-cycle) _____

Longest wait on another team _____

Waiting before start (standards wait + the larger of the two waits above) _____

D. CAPACITY

Share of team time available (%) _____

REDUCTION (JOB CUTS, COMPETING WORK, LAUNCHES)	%

Capacity (available minus reductions, %) _____

E. BLOCKED PERIODS

FREEZE, CRUNCH, AUDIT SEASON, REORG…	FROM	TO	WEEKS IN WINDOW

Blocked weeks (only those between work start and the real deadline) _____

F. RELEASE AND EVIDENCE

Code complete before the release that must comply _____

Validation, evidence and audit readiness _____

Release and evidence weeks (sum of both) _____

If the real deadline lands inside a blocked period, move it to the start of that period and add the difference here.

G. THE MATH

1	Calendar weeks (A)	_____	5	= Working weeks	_____
2	− Total handoff weeks (B)	_____	6	× Capacity (D) = **Work possible**	_____
3	− Waiting before start (C)	_____	7	Work needed (A)	_____
4	− Release and evidence (F) − Blocked (E)	_____	8	Work possible − work needed	_____

☐ **It fits** ☐ **We are short by _____ weeks** Latest date the first handoff must begin: _____

H. WIN TIME BACK: TICK YOUR BIGGEST LOSS AND ITS FIRST MOVE

- ☐ **Handoffs:** one working group with legal, compliance, security and engineering; interpret in parallel; name partner teams on day one.
- ☐ **Planning:** reserve a standing slice of every planning cycle for regulatory work.
- ☐ **Capacity:** make it an explicit priority with dedicated people; defer lower-value work.
- ☐ **Release lead time:** ship compliance on an earlier release train.
- ☐ **Waiting on guidance:** build what won't change (inventory, SBOMs, vulnerability intake) while standards settle.
- ☐ **Dependencies:** map them, agree dates in writing, escalate any without a committed date.
- ☐ **Blocked periods:** set milestones before each freeze; treat the last one as your real deadline.
- ☐ **Evidence:** generate SBOMs, validation results and audit records in the pipeline as you build.

The Compliance Relay · Version 0.4 · Created by Pooja Ravichandra · A generic planning model, not legal advice · Simplified hand calculation: the web calculator and spreadsheet give the exact answer · CC BY 4.0.